Figure 11. Distribution and Equity

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Equity												
Horizontal inequity index, %[a]	US 6.00	Canada 1.90	France 1.30	Germany 1.00	UK 0.40	Sweden NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	2.12 (n = 5)
Out-of-pocket spending												
As % of total health expenditure	CHE 26.8	Australia 18.8	Sweden 14.1	Japan 13.9	Canada 13.6	Denmark 13.4	Germany 13.2	US 11.0	UK 9.7	France 6.3	NLD 5.2	13.3
As % of household consumption	CHE 4.5	Sweden 3.4	Australia 3.2	US 2.6	Denmark 2.6	Canada 2.3	Japan 2.2	Germany 1.8	UK 1.4	France 1.4	NLD 1.3	2.4
Unmet need[b]												
Consultation skipped because of cost	US 22.3	Australia 16.2	NLD 12.5	France 9.0	CHE 7.0	Canada 6.6	UK 4.2	Sweden 3.9	Germany 2.6	Denmark NA	Japan NA	9.4 (n = 9)
% Unmet need, below-average income	US 43	CHE 31	France 30	Canada 30	NLD 29	Australia 24	Germany 16	Sweden 16	UK 8	Denmark NA	Japan NA	25 (n = 9)
% Unmet need, above-average income	US 32	CHE 22	NLD 16	France 14	Canada 13	Australia 13	UK 7	Sweden 7	Germany 6	Denmark NA	Japan NA	14 (n = 9)
Geographic breakdown												
Rural population, % of total population	CHE 26	France 20	US 18	Germany 18	Canada 18	UK 17	Sweden 14	Denmark 12	Australia 10	NLD 9	Japan 6	15
Population density per sq mile	NLD 505	Japan 348	UK 271	Germany 237	CHE 212	Denmark 136	France 122	US 35	Sweden 24	Canada 4	Australia 3	172
Urban physicians per 1000 population	Sweden 4.5	France 4.1	Canada 4.1	US 3.2	Japan 2.9	CHE 2.8	Australia 2.6	Germany 2.0	UK NA	NLD NA	Denmark NA	3.3 (n = 8)
Rural physicians per 1000 population	CHE 4.4	Sweden 3.5	France 2.5	Australia 1.7	US 1.4	Japan 1.4	Germany 1.3	Canada 0.4	UK NA	NLD NA	Denmark NA	2.1 (n = 8)

NA indicates not applicable. CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. See eTable 7 in Supplement 2 for data ordered by country.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] The horizontal inequity index is the percentage probability of a physician visit in the past 12 months by wealth. If the index is greater than 0, then high-income groups access physicians more than low-income groups after adjustment for relative need.

[b] Regarding unmet need, the Commonwealth Fund International Health Policy Survey poses a number of questions to a representative sample from each country. For this indicator, it was analyzed whether a respondent did not consult with or visit a physician because of cost, skipped a medical test, treatment, or follow-up that was recommended by a physician because of cost, or did not fill or collect a prescription for medicine or skipped doses of medicine because of cost. Low income is defined as household income less than 50% of the country median.